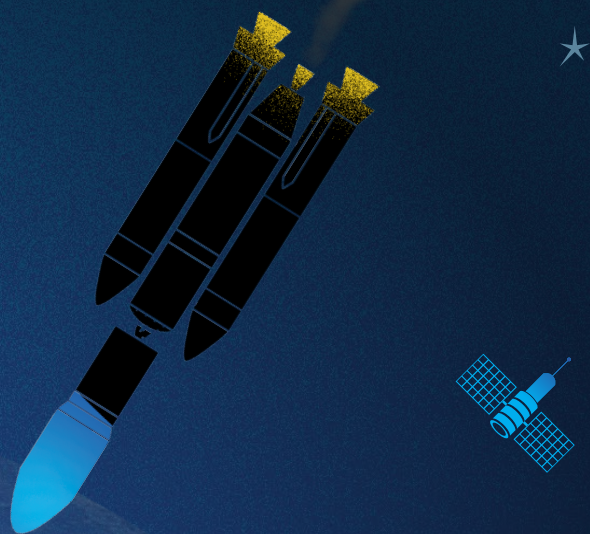




ARTEMIS ACCORDS TO THE MOON & BACK



In June, India became the 27th signatory to the Artemis Accords; expect further dialogue and agreements to establish a comprehensive and inclusive framework for space exploration



Increased technological collaboration between India and the US to help the global space economy's growth through innovation, talent and low-cost Indian technology



Space industry collaboration with the US may improve satellite manufacturing, launches and services



With 381 satellite launches for 34 countries already under its belt, India's track record as a low-cost yet high-technology launch hub will get further reinforced



Given India's young, technologically trained workforce, spacetechnologies are projected to increase, leading to more consumer-based innovation

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and how things work. The intention of any space Bill is not necessarily to regulate and make things onerous, but to provide security and guardrails around how things can be done effectively," says Varghese. That's really important to keep in mind when we are looking at more foreign companies wishing to join India's space economy, leverage Indian innovation and talent, and use more Indian talent and resources in things like [space] research and launches," she adds.

Goenka says that the Space Activity Bill will follow once the FDI norms are finalised since the operating document is part of the space policy. "The draft [Space Activity] Bill is already there. The 2017 draft Bill is not relevant anymore because a lot has changed since then. Therefore, a new draft Bill has been made, which is consistent with where we are today. Bills take time, and the new draft will go through a process," he adds.

Meanwhile, Sreedhara Panicker Somanath, Chairperson of Isro and Secretary in the Department of Space, has one piece of advice for private companies entering the space. In a country where freebies are suddenly a hot topic, spacetechnologies companies must develop business models that make their solutions affordable to millions. "We must find ways to deliver on-ground infrastructure and connectivity to millions at low cost," he recently said at an industry gathering. In agreement, Varghese explains, "At the start of the internet economy, companies had a separate internet division. Eventually, they had to consolidate. The space sector is at a similar inflection point, where every company will become a space company by harnessing some of the technologies. Whether it's healthcare, finance, or insurance, we are going to see an impact on how this space economy is unfolding."

Arthur D. Little says that as against the estimate of India's space economy touching \$40 billion by 2040, it can potentially be worth \$100 billion.

In India's case, this is likely to hold true. In June, during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's state visit to the US, India became the 27th signatory to the non-binding Artemis Accords, a multilateral agreement between the US and other countries to return humans to the moon by 2025. And as the country preps to send its first human mission into space through its low-cost Gaganyaan mission, the final frontier may well be within reach. **BT**

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